Doing the Right Thing When It Is Hard

What responsibility deserves my steadiness now?

READING

Marcus Aurelius, *Meditations* 5.1 and 5.9.
Marcus recalls his work as a human being and urges a return to sound principles after falling short. Courage sustains fitting conduct through difficulty; changing the method may help preserve the responsibility.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack with the question and reading links. Invite a modest example, such as a needed conversation. No dramatic courage required.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Optional August observation	Aloud, together	The questions below	Rehearse one difficult next step	One practice to retain

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. What makes a responsibility worth continuing when motivation fades?
2. When is persistence fitting, and when do rest, help, or a changed plan better serve it?
3. What needs saying in a difficult conversation, and how can you say it fairly?
4. After a mistake, what separates renewed effort from excuses or self-condemnation?
5. How have examining threats and aversions helped you act when the right thing has a cost?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Take the next fitting step. Choose one worthwhile responsibility and take its next concrete action when the occasion comes. If blocked or mistaken, correct what you can and choose the next step. Steadiness can include changing course; assess conduct, not applause.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"Steady toward what?" Test the purpose before encouraging perseverance. Courage remains answerable to wisdom, justice, and temperance.

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